EVIDENCE · LEDGER · STRUCTURE

kpi

Executive KPI system — one base, five layout modifiers.

Four tiles the eye sweeps in one pass.

4

tiles per row

THE CEILING ✓ ON PLAN

8

words per tile

SOFT BUDGET ✓ BOARD

5s

scan time

THE TARGET ✓ ON PLAN

0

prose sentences

ALLOWED HERE ✓ AUDIT

attention flags the tile that misses.

1

tile flagged

THE MISS – ATTENTION

3

tiles steady

FOR CONTEXT ✓ ON PLAN

0

alarms hidden

HONESTY ✓ BOARD

4

tiles total

THE ROW ✓ ON PLAN

KPI OPS

ops reads the tiles against SLOs.

99.9%

the SLO frame

TARGET LINE – SLO

4

tiles per row

UNCHANGED ✓ ON PLAN

1

breach shown

NEVER HIDDEN – OPS

30d

the window

ROLLING ✓ SLO

KPI COMPLIANCE

compliance tallies findings per framework.

0

open findings

THE GOAL ✓ CLEAN

4

frameworks tracked

ONE ROW ✓ AUDIT

1

in remediation

DATED – WATCH

KPI TRAJECTORY

trajectory pairs each tile with its delta.

+9%

the delta leads

VS PLAN ✓ UP

4

tiles still rule

PER ROW ✓ ON PLAN

−2

down is shown

NOT SPUN ✓ HONEST

spotlight gives one tile double width.

1

tile promoted

the headline ✓ SPOTLIGHT

2

support tiles

BESIDE IT ON PLAN

0

competing heroes

ONE ONLY RULE

Four tiles at full word weight.

4

the grid's seat count

A FIFTH NEVER RENDERS ✓MAX

14

words per tile, the budget

SPENDS THE ALLOWANCE ✓BUDGET

1

line per label

WRAPPING ENDS THE SCAN ✓RULE

2

slides beat one crowd

SPLIT PAST THIS ✓ADVICE

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When NOT to reach for kpi.

Decorative pills without status semantics

The pills read as status, not freeform tags. Status color is assigned by each KPI's row position within the modifier — the engine never reads the pill text — so reserve them for the status vocabulary the position implies (`On plan`, `At risk`, `Breaching`, `Compliant`, `Remediating`). Arbitrary labels land a color that has nothing to do with the words.

A fifth metric — or a fourth that is not terse

Three is the allowance at a wide @size; a fourth needs everything terse — one status pill, no eyebrow, a one-line title. A fifth fits at no label length: the export clips it and names the page. Split across slides, or use `stats`, which drops the targets and pills and holds more rows.

When NOT to reach for kpi.

Reaching for attention or spotlight to carry a fifth metric

`attention` highlights the metric that needs the room; `spotlight` monumentalizes one number. Both spend most of the stage on a single tile, so past four the hierarchy they exist to create collapses — split into two slides rather than crowding the hero.

No targets, no trends

If the KPIs carry only current values, the slide is a stats row, not a kpi dashboard. Use stats and reclaim the room.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`stats` — metric row without targets or status pills

`big-number` — a single number is the whole argument

`split-panel` — one KPI with a paragraph of supporting prose

`progress` — completion percentages across parallel workstreams

`timeline-list` — milestones in time, not metrics at a moment